Because Hydra plays such a large role in the world of Marvel Comics, Meinerding and Wen wanted to be sure to pay tribute to the source material when appropriate. Said Meinerding, “A lot of the initial design takes were just trying to figure out how to include the signature ‘H’ from the comics. Once we realized we could use the Cube tech to be part of those straps and harnesses, it came together a bit more.”

Said Wen, “Initially, I focused on a more low-tech machinery that was being powered by an extremely high-tech alien force. I tried to keep with the Industrial Age as much as possible to give greater emphasis to the era difference with the rest of the Marvel Universe, which is happening in present day. Eventually, we gravitated back to a more high-tech version of the infantry and their armament. Ryan brought some of the high-tech back into Hydra with some amazing weapons that were extremely high-tech, yet still viable for the Marvel world in the WWII period.

“Designing infantry in any media is a different sort of animal to tackle. You are designing something that needs to work in groups small and large. Something I wanted to be sure of was that our Hydra soldiers were going to be strong enough to stand by themselves on the screen, but simple enough to work well with dozens on the screen at once. So some of the images I did were to make sure the design worked together when seen in a large group of repeating shapes, colors and materials.”